

Gulf Coast Kitchen - Working Recipes

From the farm | Shrimp and oysters we raised | Cook simple, cook hot

A few recipes worked out over years of cooking what we catch and raise. Measurements are honest but loose; taste as you go. These use our own shrimp and oysters; sub what you have.

Shrimp and grits

Stone-ground grits, cooked slow in water and a little milk until creamy, finished with butter and sharp cheese. Season head-on shrimp with salt and cayenne. Render a little bacon, cook the shrimp fast in the fat with garlic, deglaze with a splash of stock and lemon. Spoon over the grits, green onion on top. Do not walk away from the shrimp; ninety seconds a side.

Seafood gumbo (short version)

- 1 Make a dark roux, equal flour and oil, stirred until it is the color of an old penny. This is the whole dish; do not rush it or burn it.
- 2 Add the trinity (onion, celery, bell pepper), cook down soft.
- 3 Stock, a little tomato if you like, the holy water of bay leaf and thyme. Simmer.
- 4 Add okra, then shrimp and oysters at the very end so they do not turn to rubber.
- 5 Serve over rice with file at the table and hot sauce for those who want it.

Chargrilled oysters

Hot grill, oysters on the half shell. Spoon of garlic-herb butter on each, a little parmesan. Close the lid until the edges curl and the butter bubbles, three to four minutes. Crusty bread to mop the shells. This is the one that converts people who say they do not like oysters.

Fried shrimp and hushpuppies

Buttermilk soak, dredge in seasoned cornmeal and flour. Fry at 360 F until just golden; they keep cooking after they come out. Hushpuppy batter is the cornmeal dredge plus egg, buttermilk, grated onion, a pinch of sugar; drop by the spoonful into the same oil. Nathan's favorite, so this gets made on his weekends.

Personal recipes. Cook seafood just to done; the most common mistake is cooking it past that.